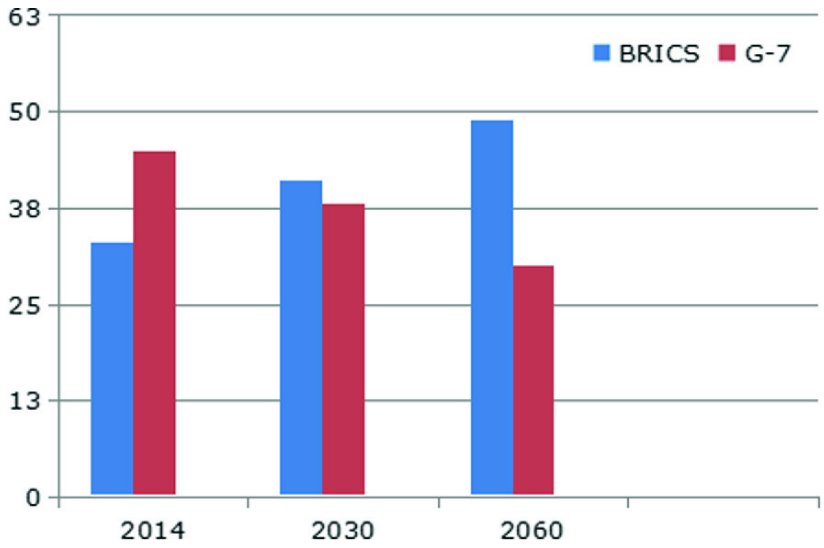



***Fig. 2.5*** Projected structure of the global economy (2014–2060)
(*Source* Economic Outlook No. 95: Long-term-Baseline Projections Dataset, Organization for Economic Cooperation for Development [OECD], May 2014. The data is calculated in percentile)

The report said that BRICS' contribution to the global economy was 33 percent only in 2014, whereas the G-7 contribution to the global economy was 45 percent in 2014. However, by 2030, BRICS would cross the G-7 group and reach 41 percent, whereas the G-7 share would reduce to 37 percent by the BRICS contribution, getting 48 percent in 2030, whereas G-7's would be around 30 percent only. That shows BRICS would dominate the twenty-first century.

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# Soft Power Nature of BRICS Group

The importance of BRICS in Russian foreign policy discourse has led to prominent positions. Soft Power is a concept that indicates the inclusion of civil society, of institutions in its regular activities, the deepening of humanitarian cooperation, and also assertive information and communication frameworks, which includes the use of modern information technology and the Internet (Budaev 2015). In fact, in every summit declaration, BRICS emphasizes the importance of civil society's role in removing grave threats to social problems. BRICS also asserts cooperation on environmental issues, societal change, and humanitarian assistance (BRICS First Declaration 2009). The new Russian Federation's 'Concept of Participation for the Russian Federation in BRICS' was drafted and passed on February 9, 2013. It clearly stated that BRICS was not established against any group or association but purely based on Soft Power diplomacy. In this context, Russian Deputy Foreign Minister S. A. Ryabkov (2013) underscored that: 'BRICS is not a bloc related organization … it is not designed for military-political, or military cooperation, and he emphasized that, in the future, BRICS will continue to gain influence and